

THE EXTERIOR

Speed means the difference between life and death for a fighter pilot, so attention was paid to squeezing an extra few miles per hour from the aircraft. Streamlining reduced drag, so flush-rivets were used on the wings, and then on later versions on the fuselage, to make the skin smoother. Other ways of increasing speed included adding ejector exhausts and a “Meredith Duct” around the radiator, which added to the main thrust provided by the propeller.

1. Ejector engine exhausts 2. Carburettor air intake
3. Cartridge ejection chutes under wing 4. Fabric patch over machine-gun port to reduce drag (rounds break fabric when gun fires) 5. Starboard navigation light 6. Tailplane fairing
7. Pitot head measures airspeed 8. Radiator air intake
9. Cockpit door with escape crowbar 10. IFF (Identification friend or foe) aerial grommet 11. Typical stenciling 12. Stencil for electrical bonding 13. Rudder trim-tab actuator 14. Tail light

